



Nights of dejection: Yuvraj Singh, Rohit Sharma and Ravindra Jadeja look forlorn after India's loss to Sri Lanka in the 2014 final. **Right:** Jos Buttler and Alex Hales helped England chase down India's 169-run target in the 2022 semifinal.

head coach, Gary Kirsten, admitted to the team being jaded and burnt out after lengthy IPL campaigns that had closely preceded the global event.

In 2012, fate dealt a cruel hand as a rampant Indian side — which had thrashed England and Pakistan, and eked out a one-run win against the Proteas — was narrowly knocked out in the Super Eights owing to a nine-wicket defeat to Australia.

India broke the Super Eight jinx in 2014 and 2016, reaching the final and semifinal, respectively, but Virat Kohli's individual brilliance wasn't enough on both occasions.

Through the 2010s, India was the most consistent T20I side among Full Members but lacked the cutting edge in crunch moments. It won 68 of its 106 matches, logging a commendable win-loss ratio of 1.888, but had no silverware to show for. On the other hand, West Indies, having lost 53 of its 101 games, won two

editions in a span of four years. Consistency was a depreciating currency in the rapidly evolving T20 marketplace dominated by new-age power hitters.

A case in point: not a single Indian batter figured in the top 20 list of batters with the highest strike rates in either 2014 or 2016. In both tournaments, Kohli played both accumulator and aggressor, registering the best strike rate by an Indian and scoring the most runs for the team. The brilliance of Kohli's duality was also indicative of India's one-dimensionality, with the T20I side often resembling an extension of the Test and one-day teams.

A similar conservatism continued to plague India at the turn of the decade, as it failed to advance to the semifinals of the 2021 T20 World Cup following consecutive defeats to Pakistan and New Zealand on sluggish pitches in Dubai. Though

